emphasized patterned relationships among actors in a system that is anarchical. For him, states were power-seeking and security-conscious, not because of human nature viewed as 'plain bad' by classical realists, but because the structure of the international system compels them to do so. Therefore, neo-realists did not overlook the prospects of cooperation among states. But the point of contention was that states, while cooperating with each other, tried to maximize their relative power and preserve their autonomy. Therefore, the neo-realists were successful in putting the neo-liberals on the defensive in the 1980s.[19]

However, during this period, efforts were embarked on by scholars to bring the two schools of thought closer. The efforts of Robert Keohane and Bary Buzan[20] were noteworthy. Bary Buzan along with Charles Jones and Richard Little tried to synthesize neo-realist and neo-liberal institutionalist positions and they introduced the concept of *deep structure*, which meant that political structure encompasses anarchy as well as hierarchy and it includes not only power and institutions but also rules and norms. They believed that anarchic society produced states that are sovereign but that in no way meant that anarchy is incompatible with cooperation. Buzan, Jones and Little were of the opinion that units of the international system have differing structures, extending from empires to republics and including state and non-state actors, in their international action, exhibit cooperative and competitive behaviours. This resulted in alliances, coalitions, regimes, norms and institutions for international cooperation. Change and continuity were brought about by the interaction between the international system and its units. On the whole, Buzan, Jones and Little retained the core elements of Waltz's structural realism but broadened it by looking into the international system as being based on anarchy but still including patterns of cooperation.

Another challenge, which came up during this time and straightaway confronted the neo-realists and neo-liberalists, was the Marxists viewpoint. The main contributions came from neo-Marxists such as Andre Gunder Frank (1967), Immanuel Wallerstein (1974) and others who formed the School of International Political Economy